

# **Digital Download: 3**

## **IAM Certifications**

### **Guide**



# IAM Certifications Guide

*Companion Digital Download — Identity and Access Management Exam  
Prep Guide*

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## Introduction

Identity and access management covers a wide range of professional certifications — from vendor-neutral credentials that test conceptual and regulatory depth, to hands-on platform exams that validate specific product skills, to newer specialised credentials in areas like non-human identities, cloud IAM, and AI agent governance.

This appendix catalogues every major certification relevant to IAM professionals as of May 2026, organised into six sections: (A) Vendor-Neutral and Professional Body; (B) Identity Governance and Administration; (C) Privileged Access Management; (D) Workforce IAM Platforms; (E) Cloud Platform Identity; and (F) Broad Cybersecurity. For each certification, you will find name, issuing body, career level, exam format, approximate cost, validity and renewal, official URL, and mapping to this book's chapters.

## How to Approach Vendor Certifications Alongside CIDPRO™

### CIDPRO: Your Conceptual Foundation

CIDPRO is vendor neutral. It tests your grasp of identity concepts, protocols, governance frameworks, compliance obligations, and operational principles — regardless of which tools your organisation runs. That vendor independence is precisely why employers value it: a CIDPRO-certified professional can walk into any identity environment and have the conceptual scaffolding to make sense of what is happening, even before touching the specific platform. CIDPRO is showing up with increasing frequency in senior IAM job descriptions as a preferred or required qualification — it signals professional seriousness in a way that a single vendor certification on its own cannot.

### Vendor Certifications: Your Operational Proof

Vendor certifications prove you can actually operate a specific platform. When an employer is hiring for a SailPoint implementation or a CyberArk PAM deployment, they need confidence that you have hands-on

capability with that particular tool. Vendor certs provide that evidence — they are the practical counterpart to CIDPRO’s conceptual breadth.

## Recommended Sequence

- **Start with CIDPRO (or study in parallel).** Build conceptual depth first. When you understand authentication protocols, access governance, and Zero Trust at a foundational level, vendor-specific training goes faster and sticks better.
- **Add your primary platform certification.** Pick the cert for the platform your organisation uses or the one that dominates your target job market. SC-300 for Microsoft Entra/Azure environments; SailPoint or Saviynt for IGA; CyberArk for PAM.
- **Specialise as your role evolves.** NHI Foundation if non-human identity governance is part of your portfolio; CISM if you move into security management; CISSP for senior security leadership; cloud certifications for cloud-first environments.
- **Renew proactively.** Most certifications have a two-to-three-year validity window. Build renewal into your annual development plan rather than scrambling when expiry is imminent.

## Most Valued Certifications by Employers — Asia-Pacific and Global

Employer preferences for certifications vary by geography, industry, and organisation size. The table below reflects the analysis of IAM job postings across Asia-Pacific and global markets as of May 2026.

| Certification                           | Why Employers Value It                                                                    | Most Valued In                                      | Book Chapters          |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| CIDPRO                                  | Vendor-neutral, covers all IAM domains, IDPro Body of Knowledge aligned                   | Global — FSI, government, consulting                | All chapters           |
| SC-300 (Microsoft)                      | Most deployed identity platform globally (Entra ID); hands-on Entra skills in high demand | Global — especially APAC, where Microsoft dominates | Ch 3, 4, 9, 10, 19, 20 |
| CyberArk (Defender / Sentry)            | PAM is #1 enterprise security priority; CyberArk is the market leader                     | Global; strong in BFSI, healthcare, and government  | Ch 19 (entire)         |
| Okta Professional / Admin               | Enterprise WIC market leader; hands-on config exam is a trusted quality signal            | Global; tech, fintech, SaaS-heavy organisations     | Ch 3, 5, 6–8, 9, 14    |
| SailPoint IIQ / Identity Security Cloud | IGA Gartner MQ Leader; enterprise demand for SailPoint skills is consistently high        | Global; large enterprise and FSI                    | Ch 6–8, 13, 19         |
| NHI Foundation (NHIMG)                  | First accredited NHI credential; NHI security is the fastest-growing IAM skills gap       | Global, security-mature organisations               | Ch 12, 19, 20, 22      |
| CISSP                                   | Executive security credential; proves breadth for senior roles                            | Global; government, defence, FSI senior roles       | All security domains   |

| Certification       | Why Employers Value It                                             | Most Valued In                           | Book Chapters |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------|
| CISM (ISACA)        | Management credential valued by boards and audit committees        | Global; APAC government, FSI, healthcare | Ch 15–16, 22  |
| Saviynt ISAA (FREE) | Free entry-level cert; excellent signal of foundational commitment | Global: graduates and career-changers    | Ch 6–8, 13    |

## Tips for Getting Employer-Funded Certification

### Link to Business Value, Not Personal Development

Frame every request around the problem it solves for the business. “SC-300 will enable me to implement Conditional Access policies that reduce our identity incident volume” lands better than “I want to get Microsoft certified.” Managers fund solutions; they are more cautious about funding aspirations.

### Bundle Multiple Certifications into One Business Case

If you need both CIDPRO and SC-300, present them together as a certification programme with a total annual cost and a combined rationale. It shows forethought and tends to be easier to get approved than two separate requests.

### Use Vendor Benefit Programmes

- **Microsoft:** Free learning paths on Microsoft Learn; exam vouchers via Azure Pass programmes
- **Okta:** Periodic discount campaigns for certification exams; partner benefit vouchers
- **CyberArk:** Training is often funded as part of customer implementation projects — ask your account team
- **SailPoint:** Partners receive training credits; some customer agreements include Identity University access
- **AWS:** Training Credits available to many AWS customers and partners
- **Google Cloud:** Google Cloud Skills Boost provides free learning paths for partner organisations
- **ISACA / ISC2:** Corporate membership programmes provide meaningful exam voucher discounts

### Commit to a 90-Day Return on Investment

Tell your manager what you will accomplish within 90 days of earning the certification. This turns a training request into a performance commitment — and commitments get approved at a much higher rate than vague development asks.

### Start Free to Demonstrate Commitment

The Saviynt ISAA (free) and SC-900 (\$99) are low-barrier proof points. Pass one, present the result to your manager, and you have concrete evidence that a larger investment in CIDPRO or a vendor certification will be completed rather than abandoned.

## Certification Reference Cards

### Vendor-Neutral & Professional Body Certifications

**Focus: Identity & Access Management — comprehensive vendor-neutral professional certification**

These certifications come from professional bodies and independent organisations. They test conceptual depth, regulatory knowledge, and professional practice rather than specific product skills. They carry the broadest recognition across the IAM profession.

**IDPro — CIDPRO | ♦ Vendor-Neutral**

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Certified Identity Professional (CIDPRO™)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Level                  | Professional (experienced practitioners)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Format                 | Proctored online via Kryterion · Multiple choice, one correct or best answer · approximately 150 questions · 3 hours · candidates cannot skip questions or return to change an answer                                                                                    |
| Approximate Cost       | USD \$750 (single fee; IDPro does not publish a member / non-member split)                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Validity / Renewal     | IDPro states that continuing education is not required to maintain the certification at this time, and publishes no expiry period. Results are issued immediately; a failed exam may be retaken after 30 days with a new voucher; the digital badge is issued via Credly |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | This entire book is dedicated to CIDPRO preparation. All 22 chapters map directly to the five CIDPRO exam objectives, and the two 75-question mock exams in companion download D-5 are tagged to the same chapters and objectives.                                       |
| Notes                  | The primary exam this book prepares you for. Highest-value vendor-neutral IAM credential available. Appears as a preferred or required qualification in senior IAM job descriptions globally.                                                                            |

**Official URL:** <https://idpro.org/cidpro/>

**Identity Management Institute — CIAM® | ♦ Vendor-Neutral**

**Focus: IAM programme design, implementation, and management**

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Certified Identity and Access Manager (CIAM®)                                                                                                                     |
| Level                  | Expert (5+ years IAM experience recommended)                                                                                                                      |
| Format                 | Online proctored exam · Study guide included · IMI membership required                                                                                            |
| Approximate Cost       | USD \$295 (includes study guide and exam)                                                                                                                         |
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years · 60 continuing education hours every 3 years                                                                                                             |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Chapters 1–22 (all objectives). Strong curriculum overlap with CIDPRO.                                                                                            |
| Notes                  | First globally registered vendor-neutral IAM credential. Well recognised in financial services, government, and healthcare across North America and Asia-Pacific. |

**Official URL:** <https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/ciam-certification/>

*Identity Management Institute — CAMS® | ♦ Vendor-Neutral*

**Focus:** Access management, access request processing, access reviews

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Certified Access Management Specialist (CAMS®)                                                                                                                               |
| Level                  | Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Format                 | Online proctored exam                                                                                                                                                        |
| Approximate Cost       | USD \$195 (includes study guide and exam)                                                                                                                                    |
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years · 60 continuing education hours every 3 years                                                                                                                        |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 10 (Authorisation), Ch 6–8 (Lifecycle), Ch 7 (Lifecycle Governance — the IGA layer), Ch 19 (PAM)                                                                          |
| Notes                  | <p>Focused specifically on access request workflows, provisioning, deprovisioning, and access review operations.</p> <p>A good fit for IGA and operations professionals.</p> |

**Official URL:** <https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/certification/>

*Identity Management Institute — CIGE® | ♦ Vendor-Neutral*

**Focus:** Identity governance strategy, policy development, thought leadership

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Certified Identity Governance Expert (CIGE®)                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Level                  | Expert / Thought Leader                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Format                 | Online proctored exam · Study guide included                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Approximate Cost       | USD \$395                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years · 60 continuing education hours every 3 years                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 7 (Lifecycle Governance — the IGA layer), Ch 15–16 (Compliance), Ch 22 (Identity at Scale)                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Notes                  | <p>A distinguished credential for IAM leaders who develop governance frameworks and standards. Recognised by regulators and senior executives.</p> <p>IMI lists no exam waiver for this credential; grandfathering is available only to qualified candidates.</p> |

**Official URL:** <https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/certification/>

*Identity Management Institute — CIMP® | ♦ Vendor-Neutral*

**Focus:** Technical IAM project implementation and system management

| Field            | Details                                            |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s) | Certified Identity Management Professional (CIMP®) |
| Level            | Technical Practitioner                             |
| Format           | Online proctored exam                              |

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Approximate Cost       | USD \$295 (includes study guide and exam)                                                                                                       |
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years · 60 continuing education hours every 3 years                                                                                           |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 1–8 (Foundations & Lifecycle), Ch 9–14 (Security), Ch 17 (Standards)                                                                         |
| Notes                  | Designed for IAM engineers, solution architects, and project managers who implement IAM systems.<br>Strong market recognition in North America. |

**Official URL:** <https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/cimp/>

*Identity Management Institute — CIST® / CIPA® / CRFS® / CDP® | ♦ Vendor-Neutral*

**Focus:** *Identity security technology, identity protection advisory, and data protection*

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Certified Identity and Security Technologist (CIST®) ·<br>Certified Identity Protection Advisor (CIPA®) ·<br>Certified Red Flag Specialist (CRFS®) ·<br>Certified in Data Protection (CDP®)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Level                  | Senior Technical □ Practitioner (varies by cert)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Format                 | Online proctored exam · Study guide included                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Approximate Cost       | CIST, CIPA and CRFS: USD \$295 each · CDP: USD \$395                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years · 60 continuing education hours every 3 years                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 9–14 (Security), Ch 19 (PAM), Ch 21 (Privacy), Ch 15–16 (Compliance)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Notes                  | CIST covers technical leadership for IAM system architects.<br>CIPA and CRFS focus on identity fraud and identity theft advisory.<br>CDP addresses data protection compliance.<br>IMI offers nine credentials in total. The ninth, Certified Metaverse Security Consultant (CMSC), covers Web3 and metaverse security and is not detailed here.<br>All IMI credentials are registered trademarks of Identity Management Institute. |

**Official URL:** <https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/certification/>

*NHI Management Group — NHI Foundation Level | ♦ Vendor-Neutral*

**Focus:** *Non-Human Identity security — service accounts, API keys, tokens, AI agents*

| Field            | Details                                                                |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s) | NHI Foundation Level Certification (8 CPD Hours)                       |
| Level            | Foundation (open to all — beginners through experienced practitioners) |

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Format                 | Self-paced online ·<br>5–6 hours ·<br>Instructor-led module videos ·<br>Module quizzes + final exam                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Approximate Cost       | Visit <a href="https://nhimg.org/nhi-training">nhimg.org/nhi-training</a> for current pricing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Validity / Renewal     | CPD Certified ·<br>8 CPD hours ·<br>Certificate signed by Lalit Choda (Mr. NHI), NHIMG Founder                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 4 (Non-Human Identities), Ch 19 (Secrets Management), Ch 20 (AI Agent Monitoring), Ch 22 (Identity at Scale)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Notes                  | The only accredited NHI-specific training and certification in the industry as of 2025. Includes a new Agentic AI module added in 2025.<br><br>Delivered by Lalit Choda — the leading global voice on NHI security. Covers NHI types and risks, lifecycle management, secrets hygiene, the AI agent intersection, and real-world breach case studies.<br><br>Highly recommended for any IAM professional given that NHI is now the #1 identity attack vector. |

**Official URL:** <https://nhimg.org/nhi-training>

***Identity Governance & Administration (IGA)***

IGA certifications validate your ability to govern identity lifecycle, run access certifications, and manage entitlements at scale. Demand is strongest in enterprise financial services and regulated industries.

*SailPoint* | ♦ IGA

***Focus: Identity Governance & Administration — Identity Security Cloud (ISC, the cloud SaaS platform renamed from IdentityNow in March 2024) and IdentityIQ (on-premises/hybrid)***

| Field            | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s) | SailPoint Certified Identity Security Administrator ·<br>SailPoint Certified Identity Security Engineer ·<br>SailPoint Certified IdentityIQ Associate ·<br>SailPoint Certified IdentityIQ Professional ·<br>SailPoint Certified IdentityIQ Engineer ·<br>SailPoint Certified IdentityIQ Architect |
| Level            | Associate → Professional → Engineer → Architect                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Format           | Proctored online (Examity) ·<br>60–120 min ·<br>Multiple-choice and scenario-based                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Approximate Cost       | Training-based credentials: USD \$150–\$200 ·<br>Role-based Professional certs: USD \$400–\$500                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years ·<br>The SailPoint Recertification Program, launched in February 2026, extends a certification by two further years for holders of the Identity Security Engineer, IdentityIQ Engineer and the new Identity Security Administrator exams; otherwise a renewal exam is required                                                                                                                                                             |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 6–8 (Identity Lifecycle), Ch 7 (Lifecycle Governance — the IGA layer), Ch 19 (PAM for entitlements), Ch 22 (Identity at Scale)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Notes                  | Two certification tracks: training-based (lower barrier, credential-level) and role-based (experience-required, proctored, higher market credibility).<br>Identity Security Cloud, renamed from IdentityNow in March 2024, is SailPoint’s cloud / SaaS platform; IdentityIQ is the on-premises platform most common in large enterprises globally. The IdentityNow-branded credentials have been retired.<br>SailPoint is a Gartner MQ IGA Leader. |

**Official URL:** <https://community.sailpoint.com/t5/SailPoint-Certifications/ct-p/product-certification-program>

Saviynt | ♦ IGA

**Focus:** Cloud-native IGA, Cloud PAM, application access governance, and AI-driven identity security

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Identity Security for the AI Age (ISAA) — FREE entry-level ·<br>Saviynt Certified Professional                                        |
| Level                  | Foundation (ISAA — free, aimed at graduates and career-changers) → Practitioner (Certified Professional)                              |
| Format                 | ISAA: Online self-paced (free) ·<br>Certified Professional: Online proctored exam                                                     |
| Approximate Cost       | ISAA: FREE (launched March 2025) ·<br>Certified Professional: see <a href="https://saviynt.com/university">saviynt.com/university</a> |
| Validity / Renewal     | 2 years ·<br>Renewal exam                                                                                                             |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 6–8 (Identity Lifecycle), Ch 7 (Lifecycle Governance — the IGA layer), Ch 15–16 (Compliance)                                       |

| Field | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Notes | <p>ISAA is a notable free certification launched in March 2025, aimed at closing the global cybersecurity skills gap.</p> <p>It includes an AI/ML module in identity security — making it the first vendor certification to cover AI-era identity governance explicitly.</p> <p>Worth considering as an entry point for graduates and career-changers.</p> <p>The Certified Professional is the practitioner-level credential for hands-on Saviynt platform work.</p> |

**Official URL:** <https://saviynt.com/university>

### ***Privileged Access Management (PAM)***

PAM certifications validate your ability to secure, manage, and audit privileged access. PAM consistently ranks as the top enterprise security spending priority across industry surveys.

*CyberArk* | ♦ PAM

***Focus: Privileged Access Management — Core PAS, EPM (Endpoint), and Identity Security (formerly Idaptive)***

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | <p>CyberArk Trustee (Foundation) ·</p> <p>CyberArk Defender PAM – PAM-DEF (Operations) ·</p> <p>CyberArk Sentry PAM – PAM-SEN (Deployment &amp; Configuration) ·</p> <p>CyberArk Guardian PAM (Architecture — requires Defender + Sentry) ·</p> <p>CyberArk Defender – EPM (Endpoint Privilege Manager) ·</p> <p>CyberArk Defender – Identity (SSO, MFA, directory integration) ·</p> <p>CyberArk CDE (Certified Delivery Engineer — Partners only)</p> |
| Level                  | Foundation (Trustee) → Operations (Defender) → Deployment (Sentry) → Architecture (Guardian)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Format                 | From November 2025: In-person only at Pearson VUE test centres · ~65–90 questions · 90 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Approximate Cost       | USD ~\$200 per exam (Trustee lower; Guardian requires prerequisites)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Validity / Renewal     | 24 months · Re-certification exam required                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 19 (PAM Operations — the entire chapter covers PAM), Ch 22 (Zero Trust at Scale), Ch 20 (Identity Monitoring)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Notes                  | <p>CRITICAL UPDATE: From November 1, 2025, all CyberArk exams are administered exclusively at Pearson VUE in-person test centres.</p> <p>Online proctored delivery is no longer available. If you are in a region with limited Pearson VUE coverage, plan your logistics early.</p> <p>CyberArk is a Gartner MQ PAM Leader and the Defender certification is one of the most widely recognised PAM credentials in enterprise security.</p>              |

**Official URL:** <https://www.cyberark.com/services-support/certification/>

BeyondTrust | ♦ PAM

**Focus: Privileged Remote Access, Password Safe, and Endpoint Privilege Management**

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | BeyondTrust Certified Administrator                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Level                  | Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Format                 | Online exam                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Approximate Cost       | See the BeyondTrust training portal                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Validity / Renewal     | 2 years                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 19 (PAM Operations), Ch 4 (NHI for service accounts)                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Notes                  | BeyondTrust is a Gartner MQ PAM Leader with strong presence in financial services, healthcare, and US government.<br>The Certified Administrator validates your ability to administer Privileged Remote Access and Password Safe. |

**Official URL:** <https://www.beyondtrust.com/resources/education>

Delinea (formerly Thycotic/Centrify) | ♦ PAM

**Focus: Secret Server (password vaulting), Privilege Manager (endpoint), and Cloud Suite**

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Delinea Certified PAM Professional                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Level                  | Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Format                 | Online exam                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Approximate Cost       | See Delinea training portal                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Validity / Renewal     | 2 years                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 19 (PAM Operations)                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Notes                  | Delinea was formed from the Thycotic-Centrify merger in 2021 and rebranded in 2022. Strong mid-market and SME PAM presence globally. Secret Server is among the most widely deployed password vaulting solutions for mid-size enterprises. |

**Official URL:** <https://delinea.com/resources/certification>

### **Workforce Identity & Access Management Platforms**

Workforce IAM platform certifications validate hands-on capability with the specific identity platforms that enterprise organisations use for employee, partner, and customer identity.

Okta | ♦ Workforce IAM

**Focus: Workforce Identity Cloud (WIC) – SSO, MFA, Lifecycle · Customer Identity Cloud (CIC/Auth0) – CIAM**

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Okta Certified Professional ·<br>Okta Certified Administrator (Hands-On Config) ·<br>Okta Certified Consultant (Hands-On Config) ·<br>Okta Certified Developer — Workforce Identity Cloud ·<br>Okta Certified Developer — Customer Identity Cloud (Auth0) ·<br>Okta Certified Technical Architect (Board defence — all prior certs required) ·<br>Okta Certified Workflows Specialty ·<br>Okta Certified Access Gateway Specialty · Auth0 Certified Developer |
| Level                  | Foundation (Professional) → Practitioner (Admin) → Specialist (Consultant/Developer) → Expert (Technical Architect)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Format                 | Online proctored via ProctorU (Meazure Learning) ·<br>Hands-on configuration lab exams                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Approximate Cost       | USD \$250 per exam (Professional/ Admin/ Consultant/ Developer) ·<br>\$100 retake ·<br>Technical Architect USD \$5,000 (board defence, quarterly window)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Validity / Renewal     | 2 years (3 years if Technical Architect earned) ·<br>Low-friction maintenance exams for renewal                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 9 (Authentication), Ch 17 (Federation/SSO Standards), Ch 6–8 (Identity Lifecycle), Ch 22 (Zero Trust at Scale), Ch 3 (CIAM — Auth0/CIC path)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Notes                  | Okta exams are hands-on configuration labs — you configure a real Okta tenant, not just answer multiple-choice questions.<br>Professional and Administrator are the most in-demand.<br>The Technical Architect certification (\$5,000, board defence format) is one of the most exclusive and rigorous identity architecture credentials available.<br>Okta is a Gartner MQ IAM Leader.                                                                       |

**Official URL:** <https://www.okta.com/services/certification/>

Microsoft | ♦ Workforce IAM

**Focus:** Microsoft Entra ID — Identity Administration, Azure Security, Cloud Security Fundamentals

| Field            | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s) | SC-900: Security, Compliance & Identity Fundamentals ·<br>SC-300: Identity and Access Administrator Associate ·<br>AZ-500: Azure Security Engineer Associate (includes Entra IAM) ·<br>SC-200: Security Operations Analyst Associate (includes Entra Monitoring) ·<br>AZ-900: Azure Fundamentals (IAM overview) |
| Level            | Fundamentals (SC-900, AZ-900) → Associate (SC-300, AZ-500, SC-200)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Format                 | Online proctored (Pearson VUE) ·<br>40–60 questions · 45–120 minutes ·<br>Free study resources on Microsoft Learn                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Approximate Cost       | SC-900 / AZ-900: USD \$99 ·<br>SC-300 / AZ-500 / SC-200: USD \$165 ·<br>Annual free renewal via Microsoft Learn assessment                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Validity / Renewal     | Role-based certifications (SC-300, AZ-500, SC-200): 1 year ·<br>Free renewal annually via online assessment at Microsoft Learn. Fundamentals certifications (SC-900, AZ-900) do not expire and need no renewal                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Entire book. SC-300 maps specifically to: Ch 9 (Auth), Ch 10 (Authz), Ch 22 (ZT), Ch 9 (MFA), Ch 7 (IGA / Governance), Ch 19 (PAM / PIM), Ch 20 (Monitoring / Sentinel)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Notes                  | SC-300 is the go-to starting certification for anyone building an IAM career in Microsoft-ecosystem organisations.<br><br>It covers Entra ID lifecycle, Conditional Access, PIM, B2B / B2C collaboration, Identity Governance, and monitoring. Microsoft Learn provides comprehensive free preparation materials.<br><br>The annual free renewal is a genuine differentiator — it keeps the credential current with platform changes at no additional cost. Microsoft holds the largest enterprise identity deployment share globally. |

**Official URL:** <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/>

*Ping Identity (inc. ForgeRock) | ♦ Workforce IAM*

**Focus:** *Federated identity (PingFederate), MFA (PingID), access management (PingAccess), and CIAM/ForgeRock AM/IDM*

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Certified PingFederate Professional ·<br>Certified PingID Specialist ·<br>Certified PingAccess Administrator ·<br>ForgeRock Certified Access Management Specialist ·<br>ForgeRock Certified Identity Management Specialist |
| Level                  | Practitioner → Specialist                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Format                 | Online exam / instructor-led training badges (Standalone Pearson VUE ForgeRock exams discontinued May 2025)                                                                                                                |
| Approximate Cost       | See <a href="https://training.pingidentity.com">training.pingidentity.com</a> for current pricing and delivery options                                                                                                     |
| Validity / Renewal     | 2–3 years                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 17 (Federation Standards), Ch 9 (Authentication), Ch 3 (CIAM — ForgeRock path)                                                                                                                                          |

| Field | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Notes | <p>⚠ IMPORTANT: Following the Ping Identity and ForgeRock merger, standalone Pearson VUE exam booking was discontinued on May 14, 2025.</p> <p>Certifications are now delivered through the unified Ping Identity training portal.</p> <p>ForgeRock certifications remain in-market and carry weight — particularly in APAC financial services and government.</p> <p>Confirm current availability at <a href="https://training.pingidentity.com">training.pingidentity.com</a> before committing to a study plan.</p> |

**Official URL:** <https://training.pingidentity.com/>

*IBM Security Verify* | ♦ *Workforce IAM*

**Focus:** *IBM Security Verify — cloud IAM, workforce SSO, CIAM, and directory integration*

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | IBM Certified Solution Advisor — Identity · IBM Certified Solution Expert — Security Verify                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Level                  | Advisor (knowledge-level) → Expert (implementation level)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Format                 | Online exam via Pearson VUE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Approximate Cost       | USD ~\$200 per exam                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Validity / Renewal     | 2 years                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 9 (Authentication), Ch 17 (Federation Standards), Ch 3 (CIAM)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Notes                  | <p>IBM Security Verify is the combined cloud IAM platform (formerly IBM ISAM and Cloud Identity).</p> <p>This certification is particularly relevant for organisations running IBM infrastructure in banking, insurance, and government — a common pattern across the Asia-Pacific public sector.</p> |

**Official URL:** <https://www.ibm.com/training/certifications/>

### *Cloud Platform Identity Certifications*

Cloud platforms run their own IAM models — IAM policies, service accounts, workload identity, and cloud-native access controls that differ meaningfully from on-premises directory-based approaches.

*Amazon Web Services (AWS)* | ♦ *Cloud*

**Focus:** *Cloud IAM — IAM policies, SCP, STS, Cognito, AWS SSO (IAM Identity Center), Secrets Manager*

| Field            | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s) | <p>AWS Certified Security – Specialty (strongest IAM coverage) ·</p> <p>AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate / Professional (includes IAM) ·</p> <p>AWS Cloud Practitioner (Foundation — IAM concepts)</p> |

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Level                  | Foundation → Associate → Specialty                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Format                 | Proctored online or in-person (Pearson VUE) ·<br>65 questions ·<br>170 minutes (Specialty)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Approximate Cost       | Foundation: USD \$100 ·<br>Associate: USD \$150 ·<br>Specialty: USD \$300                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years ·<br>Recertify by passing the same or higher exam                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 10 (Authorisation — IAM Policies), Ch 2 (Cloud and Hybrid Identity Architecture), Ch 22 (Zero Trust at Scale), Ch 4 (NHI — Secrets Manager)                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Notes                  | AWS Certified Security – Specialty is the highest-value AWS credential for IAM professionals, covering IAM Policies, SCPs, Cognito, Secrets Manager, and KMS in depth. There is no standalone IAM-only AWS certification; IAM knowledge is embedded across all AWS security exams. AWS holds the largest global cloud market share. |

**Official URL:** <https://aws.amazon.com/certification/>

Google Cloud | ♦ Cloud

**Focus:** GCP IAM — Organisation Policies, IAM Conditions, Identity-Aware Proxy, Workload Identity Federation

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Professional Cloud Security Engineer (deep GCP IAM coverage) ·<br>Associate Cloud Engineer (Foundation — IAM basics)                                                                                                                                    |
| Level                  | Associate → Professional                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Format                 | Online-proctored or onsite-proctored ·<br>50–60 questions ·<br>120 minutes                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Approximate Cost       | Associate: USD \$125 ·<br>Professional: USD \$200                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Validity / Renewal     | Associate Cloud Engineer: 3 years · Professional Cloud Security Engineer: 2 years ·<br>Recertification by re-sitting the exam, or by the shorter renewal exam (USD \$75, one hour) available from 180 days before expiry                                |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 10 (Authorisation), Ch 2 (Cloud and Hybrid Identity Architecture), Ch 4 (NHI — Workload Identity)                                                                                                                                                    |
| Notes                  | Professional Cloud Security Engineer is the most IAM-relevant GCP credential, covering organisation policies, IAM conditions, VPC Service Controls, Identity-Aware Proxy, and Workload Identity Federation for service accounts and external workloads. |

**Official URL:** <https://cloud.google.com/learn/certification/cloud-security-engineer>

### ***Broad Cybersecurity Certifications with Strong IAM Content***

These broad cybersecurity certifications contain significant IAM content and are widely held by senior IAM professionals alongside their dedicated IAM credentials.

ISC2 — CISSP | ♦ Security

***Focus: Information security — Domain 5 (Identity and Access Management) out of 8 domains***

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Level                  | Expert (5 years paid security experience required)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Format                 | Computer Adaptive Testing (CAT) ·<br>125–175 questions ·<br>4 hours ·<br>Pearson VUE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Approximate Cost       | USD \$749, plus the ISC2 Annual Maintenance Fee of USD \$135 per year                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years ·<br>120 CPE credits (40/year)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | All chapters contribute. Most relevant: Ch 9 (Auth), Ch 10 (Authz), Ch 22 (ZT), Ch 9 (MFA), Ch 15–16 (Compliance)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Notes                  | The gold-standard broad security credential. CISSP Domain 5 maps closely to the CIDPRO curriculum.<br><br>Many senior IAM professionals hold both CISSP and a dedicated IAM credential such as CIDPRO or the IMI Certified Identity and Access Manager (CIAM), which is a workforce IAM management credential rather than anything to do with customer IAM.<br><br>The CISSP Associate pathway is available for candidates who do not yet have five years of experience. |

**Official URL:** <https://www.isc2.org/certifications/cissp>

ISC2 — CCSP | ♦ Security

***Focus: Cloud security — cloud IAM, identity federation, and cloud access management***

| Field            | Details                                                                                                              |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s) | Certified Cloud Security Professional (CCSP)                                                                         |
| Level            | Expert (5 years IT, 3 years security, 1 year cloud required)                                                         |
| Format           | Computerized Adaptive Testing (CAT), online proctored ·<br>100–150 questions ·<br>up to 3 hours · pass mark 700/1000 |
| Approximate Cost | USD \$599, plus the ISC2 Annual Maintenance Fee of USD \$135 per year                                                |

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years ·<br>90 CPE credits                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 2 (Cloud and Hybrid Identity Architecture), Ch 10 (Authorisation), Ch 22 (Zero Trust at Scale)                                                                                                            |
| Notes                  | Valuable for IAM architects working across multi-cloud environments. Cloud IAM is a significant component across CCSP domains 1, 2, and 5. Often paired with CIDPRO or CISSP for cloud IAM leadership roles. |

**Official URL:** <https://www.isc2.org/certifications/ccsp>

ISACA — CISM | ♦ Security

**Focus:** Security management — governance, risk, programme development, and incident management

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s)       | Certified Information Security Manager (CISM)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Level                  | Management / Senior Practitioner (5 years IS experience, 3 years security management)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Format                 | Online or in-person (Pearson VUE) ·<br>150 questions ·<br>4 hours                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Approximate Cost       | USD \$575 (ISACA members) / \$760 (non-members)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years ·<br>120 CPE credits                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 15–16 (Compliance), Ch 22 (Identity at Scale), Ch 20 (Monitoring & Response)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Notes                  | Widely held by IAM managers and security directors.<br>Covers the information risk management and security governance foundations that underpin all IAM programme design.<br>Often paired with CIDPRO or the IMI Certified Identity and Access Manager (CIAM) for IAM leadership career paths. Note that this CIAM is a credential name, not customer IAM. |

**Official URL:** <https://www.isaca.org/credentialing/cism>

ISACA — CISA | ♦ Security

**Focus:** IS audit, control, and assurance — includes access control audit and IAM compliance

| Field            | Details                                            |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Certification(s) | Certified Information Systems Auditor (CISA)       |
| Level            | Practitioner (5 years IS audit/control experience) |

| Field                  | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Format                 | Online or in-person ·<br>150 questions ·<br>4 hours                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Approximate Cost       | USD \$575 (members) / \$760 (non-members)                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Validity / Renewal     | 3 years ·<br>120 CPE credits                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| CIDPRO Book Connection | Ch 15–16 (Compliance), Ch 7 (IGA — access reviews), Ch 19 (PAM — audit trails)                                                                                                                                                          |
| Notes                  | The premier credential for IAM governance and compliance auditors.<br>Compliance teams, internal auditors, and governance professionals in financial services and healthcare frequently hold CISA alongside a technical IAM credential. |

**Official URL:** <https://www.isaca.org/credentialing/cisa>

## Quick Reference — All Certifications

| Certification                | Issuer    | Category                   | Level               | Cost (approx) | URL                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------|-----------|----------------------------|---------------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CIDPRO                       | IDPro     | Vendor-Neutral IAM         | Professional        | \$750         | <a href="https://idpro.org/cidpro/">idpro.org/cidpro/</a>                                           |
| CIAM®                        | IMI       | Vendor-Neutral IAM         | Expert              | \$295         | <a href="https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/ciam">identitymanagementinstitute.org/ciam</a>     |
| CAMS®                        | IMI       | Access Management          | Practitioner        | \$195         | <a href="https://identitymanagementinstitute.org">identitymanagementinstitute.org</a>               |
| CIGE®                        | IMI       | Governance Expert          | Expert              | \$395         | <a href="https://identitymanagementinstitute.org">identitymanagementinstitute.org</a>               |
| CIMP®                        | IMI       | IAM Implementation         | Technical           | \$295         | <a href="https://identitymanagementinstitute.org">identitymanagementinstitute.org</a>               |
| CIST® / CIPA® / CRFS® / CDP® | IMI       | Security Tech / Protection | Practitioner+       | \$295–395     | <a href="https://identitymanagementinstitute.org">identitymanagementinstitute.org</a>               |
| NHI Foundation               | NHIMG     | Non-Human Identity         | Foundation          | See website   | <a href="https://nhimg.org/nhi-training">nhimg.org/nhi-training</a>                                 |
| SailPoint (IIQ / ISC)        | SailPoint | IGA                        | Associate–Architect | \$150–500     | <a href="https://community.sailpoint.com/certifications">community.sailpoint.com/certifications</a> |
| Saviynt ISAA (FREE)          | Saviynt   | IGA / AI Identity          | Foundation          | FREE          | <a href="https://saviynt.com/university">saviynt.com/university</a>                                 |

| Certification               | Issuer        | Category                | Level             | Cost (approx) | URL                                |
|-----------------------------|---------------|-------------------------|-------------------|---------------|------------------------------------|
| CyberArk Trustee–Guardian   | CyberArk      | PAM                     | Foundation–Expert | ~\$200/exam   | cyberark.com/certification         |
| BeyondTrust Admin           | BeyondTrust   | PAM                     | Practitioner      | See website   | beyondtrust.com/education          |
| Delinea PAM Prof.           | Delinea       | PAM                     | Practitioner      | See website   | delinea.com/certification          |
| Okta Pro/ Admin/ Consultant | Okta          | Workforce IAM + CIAM    | Foundation–Expert | \$250–\$5,000 | okta.com/certification             |
| SC-900                      | Microsoft     | Security Fundamentals   | Fundamentals      | \$99          | learn.microsoft.com/certifications |
| SC-300                      | Microsoft     | Entra ID Administration | Associate         | \$165         | learn.microsoft.com/certifications |
| AZ-500                      | Microsoft     | Azure Security (+ IAM)  | Associate         | \$165         | learn.microsoft.com/certifications |
| Ping/ ForgeRock             | Ping Identity | Federation / SSO / CIAM | Practitioner      | See website   | training.pingidentity.com          |
| IBM Security Verify         | IBM           | Workforce / CIAM        | Advisor–Expert    | ~\$200        | ibm.com/training/certifications    |
| AWS Security Specialty      | AWS           | Cloud IAM               | Specialty         | \$300         | aws.amazon.com/certification       |
| GCP Security Engineer       | Google        | Cloud IAM               | Professional      | \$200         | cloud.google.com/certification     |
| CISSP                       | ISC2          | Broad Security          | Expert            | \$749         | isc2.org/certifications/cissp      |
| CCSP                        | ISC2          | Cloud Security          | Expert            | \$599         | isc2.org/certifications/ccsp       |
| CISM                        | ISACA         | Security Management     | Senior            | \$575–760     | isaca.org/credentialing/cism       |
| CISA                        | ISACA         | IS Audit                | Practitioner      | \$575–760     | isaca.org/credentialing/cisa       |

## Accuracy Note

Certification costs, formats, and URLs are accurate as of Aug 2026. Certification programmes change regularly — always check the official URL before registering. Where exam formats have changed significantly (CyberArk moving to in-person only; Ping Identity / ForgeRock exam restructuring), specific notices appear in the relevant certification card above.

Download all companion resources at: [https://github.com/akudrati/CIDPRO\\_Book](https://github.com/akudrati/CIDPRO_Book)